Lesson plan · for the teacher

When data goes wrong: handling an incident

Cyber security · Level 3 · Lesson 4

Time	Materials
40 min	Board and chalk; Three handwritten incident cards per group; A sheet of paper for an incident log (optional)

Learning goals

- Recognise a data incident.
- Follow the five steps: contain, report, assess, notify, learn.
- Report early, and help others report without fear.

Activity: Incident cards

1. Warm-up (5 min): Tell the burst-pipe story: water floods a classroom. Ask pupils what they would do first, and who they would tell.
2. Teach (8 min): Write the five steps on the board: contain, report, assess, notify, learn. Link each one to the burst pipe.
3. Incident cards (15 min): Each group gets a card: a lost phone, a photo sent to the wrong group, a hacked game account. They decide the first thing to do, who to tell, and what would stop it happening again.
4. Share (7 min): Each group acts out its first two minutes. The class checks: did they contain it, and did they tell someone?
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Exit ticket: each pupil writes one incident and the first thing they would do. Praise anyone who chose to tell an adult quickly.

Before the lesson, write one set of incident cards per group: “Your phone is lost on the bus”, “You sent a class photo to the wrong group”, “Your game account is sending strange messages to your friends”.

Discussion

- Why does telling quickly keep the damage small?
- Who would you tell at our school?
- What could stop this happening again?

Exit ticket

- One incident + the first thing I would do.

Try it in class tomorrow

Give each group a card: a lost phone, a photo sent to the wrong group, a hacked game account. Each group decides the first thing to do, who to tell, and what would stop it happening again, then shares with the class.

Worksheet · for pupils

When data goes wrong: handling an incident

Cyber security · Level 3 · Lesson 4

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **Your email has started sending scam messages to parents. Which step comes first?**

- ◯ Learn: write down what went wrong
- ◯ Contain: change the password and sign out of every device
- ◯ Notify: email parents a long explanation from the same account

2 **Put the five steps in order.**

- ☐ Learn: change one thing so it doesn't happen again
- ☐ Notify the people affected
- ☐ Assess what data it was, and whose
- ☐ Report it to the head teacher the same day
- ☐ Contain: stop the damage spreading

3 **Which of these are data incidents?**

- ☐ A USB stick with exam papers left in a cyber café
- ☐ A teacher's phone with pupils' numbers is stolen
- ☐ Marks are sent to the wrong group
- ☐ The school printer runs out of ink
- ☐ A parent asks to see their own child's record

4 **If you send data to the wrong group by mistake, it's best to delete it quietly and say nothing, so you don't get into trouble.**

◯ True ◯ False

5 **Match each incident to its first containing action.**

Marks sent to the wrong group	• • • •	Unplug it from the network
A lost phone	• • • •	Change the password; sign out everywhere
An email sending scams	• • • •	Lock or erase it from another device
A ransom note on the office computer	• • • •	Delete for everyone; ask parents to delete it

Think of an incident you've seen or heard of at a school: a lost phone, a message to the wrong group. Which of the five steps was missed, or done late?